Prime Minister Shamir, who had instructed us to present a longer-term intelligence assessment, beyond the yearly one, did so with the knowledge that the strategic team existed and that he was to be its first "client." Here, too, for security reasons, I will reveal only some of what our presentation included. I began my remarks with a recommendation regarding a country that was seemingly not a formally defined threat to Israel. Pakistan is not included in our definition of the Middle East, unlike the American (both the CIA's and the State Department's) definition of the region, which does include this state. Many observers view Pakistan, a Muslim country with a large arsenal of nuclear weapons and means of delivery, as the world's least responsible country with regard to nuclear proliferation—and it is assisting Iran in its own efforts to develop nuclear weapons whose goal is to threaten us. In our view, I said, it was important and even urgent to include Pakistan in our definition of the Middle East, with all of the implications that this involves.

The following were the threats I presented in January 1991:

- The greatest danger was the combination of Islamic fundamentalism and nuclear capability. A nuclear Iran run by a group of fanatical ayatollahs with their finger on a nuclear trigger would be an imminent threat to the State of Israel and to the stability of the Middle East and the world at large.
- By the end of the decade, it would be impossible to exclude the possibility that another country in the Middle East would undergo a process of Islamization. In this context, we specifically mentioned Turkey and Egypt.
- The Islamization of another state in the Middle East would be a blow to the diplomatic process, and if it were a state belonging to our innermost circle, we had to prepare for the possibility that this country would withdraw from a peace agreement and pursue confrontation.
- We estimated that within the range of our assessment, that is, ten years at most, the Arab countries would not be prepared to pay "the price of peace" required of them, even with the economic prosperity they would receive in return.
- Regarding Iraq, which was the number one destabilizing factor in the Middle East, we asked in January 1991: Where was it heading? Would it